# MARISSA E. THOMPSON

Department of Sociology | Columbia University | 606 W. 122nd Street, New York, NY 10027
marissa.thompson@columbia.edu | MarissaEThompson.com

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social Stratification • Sociology of Education • Race & Ethnicity • Public Policy

## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

**Columbia University** 2022-present
Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology
Co-Director, Center for the Study of Wealth and Inequality
Faculty Affiliate, Columbia Population Research Center
Faculty Affiliate, Data Science Institute

**University of Michigan** 2021-2022
Postdoctoral Fellow, Education Policy Initiative, Ford School of Public Policy
Research Affiliate, Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics

## EDUCATION

**Ph.D., Sociology of Education & Education Policy** 2021
Stanford University

**M.A., Sociology** 2019
Stanford University

**B.S.E., Chemical and Biomolecular Engineering** 2016
*magna cum laude*
University of Pennsylvania

## PUBLICATIONS

* denotes joint lead authorship, ˆ denotes student co-author

**Peer-Reviewed Publications:**

2026 **Marissa E. Thompson**, Sam Trejo, AJ Alvero, and Daphne O. Martschenko. "*'Being Black is Not Just Some Costume'*: How Black Americans narrate moral judgments regarding racial boundary-crossing." *Social Problems.* [Paper]

2026 Elizabeth Burland, Jasmina Camo-Biogradlija, Kelcie Ferrara-Gersonˆ, Xavier Fieldsˆ, Katherine Michelmore, Nathan Sotherlandˆ, Kevin Stange, **Marissa E. Thompson**, and Megan Tompkins-Stange. (authorship alphabetical). "Bureaucracy and Burden: Understanding Take-up of a Need-Based Financial Aid Program." *American Educational Research Journal.* [Paper]

2026 **Marissa E. Thompson**, Sam Trejo, AJ Alvero, and Daphne O. Martschenko. "Policing the boundaries of Blackness: How Black and White Americans evaluate racial self-identifications." *American Journal of Sociology.* [Paper] [Data/Code] [Pre-Registration]

2026 **Marissa E. Thompson**. "'Paper, practice, ancestry, culture': Racial frames and contested racial/ethnic census categories." *Social Forces.* [Paper]

2026 **Marissa E. Thompson**, AJ Alvero, Sam Trejo and Daphne O. Martschenko. "*What does it mean to be Black?*: Experimental evidence on the situational deployment of racial schemas." *Sociology of Race and Ethnicity.* [Paper] [Data/Code] [Pre-Registration]

2024 **Marissa E. Thompson**, Tobias Dalberg, and Elizabeth E. Bruch. "Gender Segregation and Decision-Making in Undergraduate Course-Taking." *Sociological Science.* [Paper] [Data/Code]

2024 **Marissa E. Thompson**. "The Effect of Academic Outcomes, Equity, and Student Demographics on Parental Preferences for Schools: Evidence from a Survey Experiment." *Social Forces.* [Paper] [Data/Code] [Pre-Registration]
- Best Post-PhD Paper Award (Co-Winner), Sociology of Education Association, 2025

2024 **Marissa E. Thompson*** and Sam Trejo*. "*My* School District Isn't Segregated: Experimental Evidence on the Effect of Information on Parental Preferences Regarding School Segregation." *Sociology of Education.* [Paper] [Data/Code] [Pre-Registration]

2024 **Marissa E. Thompson**. "Examining the Black Gender Gap in Educational Attainment: The Role of Exclusionary School Discipline & Criminal Justice Contact." *Social Forces.* [Paper]

2023 **Marissa E. Thompson**, Christina Weiland, Meghan P. McCormick, Catherine Snow, and Jason Sachs. "The Role of Early Schooling in Shaping Inequality in Academic, Executive Functioning, and Social-Emotional Skills." *Socius.* [Paper]

2023 René F. Kizilcec, Rachel B. Baker, Elizabeth Bruch, Kalena E. Cortes, Laura T. Hamilton, David Nathan Lang, Zachary A. Pardos, **Marissa E. Thompson**, and Mitchell L. Stevens. "From Pipelines to Pathways in the Study of Academic Progress." *Science* (Policy Forum). [Paper]

2023 Kaylee T. Matheny*, **Marissa E. Thompson***, Carrie Townley-Flores*, and Sean F. Reardon. "Uneven Progress: Recent Trends in Academic Performance Among U.S. School Districts." *American Educational Research Journal.* [Paper]

2021 **Marissa E. Thompson**. "Grade Expectations: The Role of First-Year Grades in Predicting the Pursuit of STEM Majors for First- and Continuing-Generation Students." *The Journal of Higher Education.* [Paper]

2021 Sorathan Chaturapruek, Tobias Dalberg, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Sonia Giebel, Monique H. Harrison, Ramesh Johari, Mitchell L. Stevens, and René Kizilcec. "Studying Undergraduate Course Consideration at Scale." *AERA Open.* [Paper] [Data/Code]

2020 Adina D. Sterling, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Shiya Wang, Abisola Kusimo, Shannon Gilmartin, and Sheri Sheppard. "The Confidence Gap Predicts the Gender Pay Gap Among STEM Graduates." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences.* [Paper]

2019 Shannon Gilmartin, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Emily Morton, Helen Chen, Anne Colby, and Sheri Sheppard. "Entrepreneurial Intent of Engineering and Business Undergraduate Students." *Journal of Engineering Education.* [Paper]

2016 Ki Jun Yu, Duygu Kuzum, Suk Won Hwang, Bong Hoon Kim, Halvor Juul, Nam Heon Kim, Sang Min Won, Ken Chiang, Michael Trumpis, Andrew G. Richardson, Huanyu Cheng, Hui Fang, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Hank Bink, Delia Talos, Kyung Jin Seo, Hee Nam Lee, Seung Kyun Kang, Jae Hwan Kim, Jung Yup Lee, Younggang Huang, Frances E. Jensen, Marc A. Dichter, Timothy H. Lucas, Jonathan Viventi, Brian Litt, and John A. Rogers. "Bioresorbable Silicon Electronics for Transient Spatiotemporal Mapping of Electrical Activity from the Cerebral Cortex." *Nature Materials.* [Paper]

**Manuscripts Under Review:**

Adina D. Sterling, **Marissa E. Thompson**, and Devon Rojas^. "When Employer Commitment Does (Not) Produce Racialized Effects in Hiring." Revise & resubmit, *Journal of Economics, Race, and Policy.*

**Marissa E. Thompson**. "What is fair? Need, benefit, and the compensatory distribution of limited educational resources." Under Review.

**Marissa E. Thompson**, Katherine Michelmore, Kelcie Ferrara-Gerson^, Nathan Sotherland^, and Kevin Stange. "One Fell Through the Safety Net: Embeddedness and the Take Up of Social Benefits." Under Review. [Working Paper]

Sam Trejo and **Marissa E. Thompson**. "DNA Reveals the Growing Ancestral Diversity of the United States." Under Review.

**Policy Briefs & Other Publications:**

2026 Kevin Stange, Kelcie Ferrara-Gerson, Margaret Peterman, Nelson Oviedo, Nathan Sotherland, Nicole Wagner Lam, **Marissa E. Thompson**, and Katherine Michelmore. "The Effectiveness of Need-Based Financial Aid: Evidence from Michigan's Tuition Incentive Program." EPI Policy Brief. [Link]

2024 Kelcie Gerson, Katherine Michelmore, Nathan Sotherland, Kevin Stange, and **Marissa E. Thompson**. "Michigan's Tuition Incentive Program: An Initial Look at Take-up." EPI Policy Brief. [Link]

2021 **Marissa E. Thompson**. "Who's getting pulled in weed-out courses for STEM majors?" Brown Center Chalkboard, Brookings Institution. [Link]

## GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Postdoctoral Fellowship, National Academy of Education & Spencer Foundation – $70,000 2024-2025

Russell Sage Foundation & Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation Pipeline Grant – $35,000 2024
for "*What is fair? Disentangling public conceptions of merit and equity in the age of inequality*"
P.I. Marissa Thompson

Hettleman Junior Faculty Summer Research Grant, Columbia University – $6,000 2024

Alliance Joint Projects Grant, Columbia University & Sciences Po (Paris) – $15,000 2023
for *"A Columbia-Sciences Po Joint Course: Race, Discrimination, and Racial Inequalities on Both Sides of the Atlantic"*
P.I.s Thomas DiPrete, Mirna Safi & Marissa Thompson

Columbia Population Research Center Seed Grant, Columbia University – $20,000 2022
for *"Race, Genetic Ancestry, and Context: Exploring How Genetic Ancestry Tests Influence Conceptions of Race"*
P.I.s Marissa Thompson, Sam Trejo, Daphne Martschenko, & AJ Alvero

Institute of Education Sciences (IES) Grant – $2,702,034 2022-2026
for *"Early First-Dollar Categorical Need-Based Aid: A New Model for Making College Affordable?"*
P.I. Kevin Stange

Postdoctoral Training Fellowship, Institute of Education Sciences (IES) – $55,000 2021-2022

Center for American Democracy Grant, Stanford University – $2,000 2020-2021
for *"Understanding Parental Attitudes Towards School Segregation"*
P.I.s Marissa Thompson and Sam Trejo

Karr Family Fellowship, Stanford University – $19,000 2018-2019

Predoctoral Training Fellowship, Institute of Education Sciences (IES) – $60,000 2017-2019

Graduate Fellowship in Science and Engineering, Stanford University – $125,100 2016-2021

Enhancing Diversity in Graduate Education Fellowship, Stanford University – $12,800 2016-2021

## HONORS & AWARDS

Outstanding Reviewer Award, *Sociology of Education* 2026
Best Post-PhD Paper (Co-Winner), Sociology of Education Association 2025
Outstanding Predoctoral Fellow Award, Institute of Education Sciences (IES) 2021
Zeisberg Best Research Award in Chemical Engineering, American Institute of Chemical Engineers 2017
Melvin C. Molstad Prize in Chemical Engineering, University of Pennsylvania 2016
Exceptional Service Award, University of Pennsylvania 2016

## RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

**Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)**
Invited Researcher 2025-2028

**University of Chicago**
Affiliate, Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality and Mobility 2023-2027

**Stanford University**
Affiliate, Pathways Network 2021-present

## TEACHING

**Columbia University**

The Social World – Introduction to Sociology (Undergraduate): Spring 2026, Spring 2027
Education and Inequality (Undergraduate): Spring 2024, Spring 2026, Spring 2027
Race, Discrimination, and Racial Inequalities on Both Sides of the Atlantic (Undergraduate): Fall 2023, Fall 2025, Fall 2026
Sociology of Education (Graduate): Fall 2022
Workshop on Wealth and Inequality (Graduate): Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Spring 2024

## INVITED PRESENTATIONS

(includes scheduled presentations)

2027 University of Pennsylvania, Wharton Management Department

University of Texas at Austin, Population Research Center
New York University - Abu Dhabi, Social Research and Public Policy Speaker Series

2026 RC-28 Thematic Meeting on Educational Inequalities (Keynote)
University of California Berkeley, Department of Sociology
University of Pennsylvania, Graduate School of Education
Purdue University, Department of Sociology
University of Notre Dame, Center for Research on Educational Opportunity

2025 University of California Los Angeles, California Center for Population Research
Brown University, Annenberg Institute
Princeton University, Office of Population Research
Princeton University, Education Research Section
Vanderbilt University, Peabody Education Policy Seminar Series
Sciences Po Paris, Centre for Research on Social Inequalities
New York University, Sociology of Culture Workshop

2024 University of Pennsylvania, Population Studies Center
ENSAE Paris, Center for Research in Economics and Statistics
Sciences Po Paris, Centre for Research on Social Inequalities
University of Chicago, Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality and Mobility
University of Oxford, Classical and Computational Social Science Working Group
Stanford University, Center for Education Policy Analysis
Stanford University, Educational Opportunity Project & Institute for Advancing Just Societies

2023 University of Michigan, Center for Academic Innovation
University of Houston, Identity & Academic Motivation Lab
Columbia University, Population Research Center
Pennsylvania State University, Population Research Institute
Yale University, Center for Empirical Research on Stratification and Inequality
University of Wisconsin - Madison, Wisconsin Center for Educational Research
University of Wisconsin - Madison, Experimental Methods in Sociology Workshop

2022 Columbia University, Center for the Study of Wealth and Inequality
Drexel University, Pennoni Honors College (Panel)
Pennsylvania State University, College of Education
Columbia University, Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences Research Seminar

2020 École Normale Supérieure, Département d'Études Cognitives

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

(includes scheduled presentations)

2026 RC-28: Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility (Seville, Spain)
*Sociological Science* Conference (Stanford, CA)
American Sociological Association (New York, NY)

2025 Sociology of Education Association (Pacific Grove, CA)
Population Association of America (Washington, D.C.)
*Sociological Science* Conference (Ithaca, NY)

2024 Sociology of Education Association (Pacific Grove, CA)
American Sociological Association (Montreal, Canada)

Race & Ancestry Symposium (University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA)

2023 Sociology of Education Association (Pacific Grove, CA)
Population Association of America (New Orleans, LA)
RC-28: Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility (Paris, France)
American Sociological Association (Philadelphia, PA)

2022 American Sociological Association (Los Angeles, CA)
Association of Black Sociologists (Chicago, IL)

2021 American Sociological Association (Virtual)
Association for Education Finance and Policy (Virtual)
Empowering Learners in AI (Virtual)

2020 Association for the Study of Higher Education (Virtual)

2019 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (Denver, CO)
Sociology of Education Association (Pacific Grove, CA)
Association for Education Finance and Policy (Kansas City, MO)
American Sociological Association (New York, NY)

2018 American Society of Engineering Education (Salt Lake City, UT)
American Sociological Association (Philadelphia, PA)

## DEPARTMENTAL & UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Graduate Admissions Committee, Columbia University 2023, 2026
Graduate & Undergraduate Thesis Prize Committee, Columbia University 2024

**Student Advising:**

*PhD Dissertation Chair/Co-Chair*

Katerine Perez (Sociology, Columbia University, in progress)

*PhD Dissertation Committee*

Eva Chen (Sociology, Columbia University, in progress)
Jabari Cook (Sociology & Social Policy, Princeton University, in progress)
Elizabeth Adetiba (Sociology, Columbia University, 2025)
Bonnie Siegler (Sociology, Columbia University, 2025)
Dominic Walker (Sociology, Columbia University, 2024)
Asya Tsaturyan (Sociology, Columbia University, 2024)
Abbey Keener (Education, Columbia University, 2024)
Taylor Alexander (Education, University of Houston, 2023)

*MA Thesis Advising*

Alya Al Shehhi (Sociology, Columbia University, in progress)
Kayla Smernoff (Sociology, Columbia University, 2026)
Amita Khurana (Sociology, Columbia University, 2024)

*Undergraduate Advising*

Gulnazik Bakhramova (Harriman Institute Summer Research Fellowship, Columbia University, 2026)
Kelly Yoshimura (Laidlaw Summer Program, Columbia University, 2023 & 2024)

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & MEMBERSHIPS

Program Committee, Eastern Sociological Society Annual Meeting 2027
Council Member, ASA Section on Inequality, Poverty, & Mobility 2026-2029
Editorial Board, *Sociology of Education* 2026-2029

| | |
|---|---|
| Outstanding Student Publication Award Committee, ASA Section on Biology & Society | 2026 |
| Council Member, ASA Section on Biology & Society | 2025-2026 |
| Participatory Budgeting Committee, ASA Section on Inequality, Poverty, & Mobility | 2025-2026 |
| Nominations Committee, ASA Section on Sociology of Education | 2025-2026 |
| Fall Conference Program Chair, Sociology of Education Association | 2024 |
| Session Organizer, PAA Annual Meeting | 2024 |
| Board of Directors, Sociology of Education Association | 2023-2025 |
| Outstanding Publication Award Committee, ASA Section on Methodology | 2023 |
| Clifford Clogg Award Committee, ASA Section on Methodology | 2022 |
| Council Member (Student), ASA Section on Methodology | 2021-2023 |

**Professional Association Memberships:**
American Sociological Association (ASA)
Association of Black Sociologists (ABS)
Population Association of America (PAA)
RC-28: Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility
Sociology of Education Association (SEA)

**Occasional Reviewer:**
*AERA Open, American Educational Research Journal, American Journal of Sociology, American Sociological Review, European Sociological Review, International Journal of Comparative Sociology, J-PAL North America Grants, Nature Human Behaviour, Peabody Journal of Education, Social Currents, Social Forces, Social Problems, Social Science Research, Sociological Focus, Sociological Science, Sociology of Education, Socius, The Journal of Higher Education, The Sociological Quarterly, Time-Sharing Experiments in the Social Sciences (TESS) Grants*